Go to sleep.' R. T. H. Griffith, *The hymns of the Rigveda*, 7.55.2-5, 1889.

22 For my datings of the Vedas I have drawn mostly on Irfan Habib and V. K. Kumar, *The Vedic Age*, 2003.

23 H. H. Wilson, *The Vishnu Purana: a System of Hindu Mythology and Tradition*, 1840.

24 Griffith was for many years principal of Benares College before retiring to the hill-station of Kotagiri in the Nilgiri mountains, where he made many of his translations and where he died in 1906.

25 R. T. H. Griffith, The *hymns of the Atharvaveda*, 1895.

26 R. T. H. Griffith, *The hymns of the Rigveda*, 10, 90, 11-12, 1889.

27 C. E. Gover, 'The Pongol festival in Southern India', *Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, New Series Vol. V, 1870.

CHAPTER 3: AGASTYA'S COUNTRY

1 M. Ariel, in a letter in *Journal Asiatique*, Nov–Dec 1849, quoted in G. U. Pope, *The sacred Kurral of Tiruvalluva Nayanar*, 1886.

2 See Thomas Trautmann, *The Madras school of Orientalism: producing knowledge in colonial South India*, 2009.

3 Tamil grammars had earlier been printed in Germany and in Danish Tranquebar in 1738. See Stuart H. Blackburn, *Print, Folklore and Nationalism in Colonial South India*, 2003. My thanks to Dr Crispin Branfoot for drawing this to my attention.

4 J. W. McCrindle, *The Commerce and Navigation of the Erythræan Sea; being a translation of the Periplus Maris Erythraei*, 1879.

5 Unusually, Kamban was not a Brahmin but an *Uvachchar*, a sub-caste of temple servants whose